

INTERNAL EBU RULES ON HANDLING IRREGULARITIES IN VOTING

- INTERNAL USE ONLY -

Eurovision Song Contest 2026

document developed by

ONCE

APPROVAL AND ACCEPTANCE

This document has been approved and accepted by the European Broadcasting Union (EBU) and acknowledged by the Independent Voting Observer Ernst and Young (EY).

ONCE is instructed and authorized to conduct the Eurovision Song Contest 2026 voting in accordance with these guidelines.

Geneva, _____, _____

European Broadcasting Union (EBU) Ernst and Young (EY)

TABLE OF CONTENTS

1. Determining the score and allocation of the 12 points

- 1.1 Difference between Votes, Ranks and Points
- 1.2 Audience Voting
 - 1.2.1 Tie Situations
- 1.3 Jury Voting
 - 1.3.1 Tie Situations
- 1.4 Score calculation Semi Finals
- 1.5 Score calculation Grand Final
- 1.6 Score Calculation San Marino
- 1.7 Solving Ties in the combined result

2. Result Presentation

- 2.1 Results Presentation in the Semifinals
- 2.2 Announcement of the Points
- 2.3 Presenting the Audience Result
- 2.4 Solving Tie Situations

3. Pot System and Fallback Scenarios

- 3.1 Information about the pot-system and calculations
- 3.2 ESC 2026 Pots
- 3.3 Fallback Scenarios

4. Jury Voting

- 4.1 Usage of the Jury Vote
- 4.2 Irregularities in jury voting
- 4.3 Handling of irregularities in jury voting
 - 4.3.1 Tie Situations

5. Audience Voting

- 5.1 Voting Windows
- 5.2 Usage of the Audience Vote
- 5.3 Automatic Handling of Irregularities
- 5.4 Manual Handling of errors and irregularities
- 5.5 Allowed Neighboring and Diaspora voting

6. Rest of the World Voting

- 6.1 Voting Windows
- 6.2 Usage of the RoW Vote
- 6.3 Identification and handling of Errors and Irregularities
- 6.4 Fallback Scenarios

7. Disqualification of a participant

1. DETERMINING THE SCORE AND ALLOCATION OF THE 12 POINTS

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1.1 DIFFERENCE BETWEEN VOTES, RANKS AND POINTS

Votes

The votes come from the Audience voting and consists of

1. the centralized audience voting which collects all votes made by the audience via fixed line, SMS and/or online paid voting from each participating country;
2. the votes from the non-participation countries which are calculated together and treated as an additional country (Rest of the World country, aka RoW).

With respect to Audience voting, in each country, the song which has received the highest number of votes shall be ranked first, the song which has received the second highest number of votes shall be ranked second and so on until the last song.

Jury Ranks

Similarly, the sum of the individual results of the national jurors are ranked in each country, the song which has received the highest sum shall be ranked first, the song which has received the second highest sum shall be ranked second and so on until the last song.

Points

The points to the top ten contestants are awarded by the audiences and the national juries and calculated based on the final ranks of the audience and jury voting respectively.

*rank 1 = 12 points, rank 2 = 10 points, rank 3 = 8 points, rank 4 = 7 points, rank 5 = 6 points,
rank 6 = 5 points, rank 7 = 4 points, rank 8 = 3 points, rank 9 = 2 points, rank 10 = 1 points à a total of 58 points*

1.2 AUDIENCE VOTING

With respect to the Audience voting, the song which has received the highest number of votes shall be ranked first, the song which has received the second highest number of votes shall be ranked second and so on until the last song.

In both Semi-Finals and in the Grand Final, only the ten best ranked songs in the Audience voting will be considered and

- (1) 12 points shall be allocated to the song having obtained the best rank from the audiences;
- (2) 10 points to the song having obtained the second-best rank from the audiences,
- (3) 8 points to the song having obtained the third-best combined rank from the audiences,
- (4) 7 points to the next,
- (5) and so on, down to 1 point for the song having obtained the tenth-best rank from the audiences.

1.2.1 TIE SITUATIONS

TIE DUE TO THE SAME NUMBER OF POINTS FROM ALL AUDIENCES (National and RoW)

Should there be a tie, because two songs have received the same number of points from all the National Audiences, the winner shall be the song which

- § has obtained points from the highest number of Audiences (National and RoW).
- § If the tying songs have received points from the same number of Audiences, the highest number of 12-point scores shall be decisive.
- § If the winner still cannot be determined by this procedure, the number of times ten points have been awarded shall be the deciding factor.

If necessary, this method shall continue until account has been taken of the number of times one point has been awarded. In the very unlikely case that after applying the above procedure there is still a tie, the tie shall be resolved by giving precedence to the country which was earlier in the running order for the Show concerned.

1.2.1 TIE SITUATIONS

TIE DUE TO THE SAME NUMBER OF VOTES FROM THE NATIONAL AUDIENCE IN A GIVEN COUNTRY

Should two or more songs receive exactly the same number of votes from the National Audience in a given participating country, the results of the National Jury shall be used to determine their respective ranks (i.e. the song having obtained the best rank from the National Jury shall be ranked highest).

In the event, that a National Jury Result has been disqualified by the EBU, the Jury Pot Result for the respective country is used to solve the tie in the aforementioned situation.

TIE DUE TO THE SAME NUMBER OF VOTES FROM THE RoW AUDIENCE

Should two or more songs receive exactly the same number of votes from the RoW Audience via the paid online voting in the non-participating countries, the tie shall be resolved by using the overall jury result from the countries within pot 0 (The pot of the Big 4, and the HB).

1.3 JURY VOTING

With respect to the National Jury voting, the jury members shall rank first their favorite song, second, their second favorite song, third, their third favorite song, and so on until their least favorite song which shall be ranked last. Abstentions are not allowed, except that the song representing the country of the Participating Broadcaster which has appointed the National Jury shall be excluded from the vote.

NEW: Every National Jury consists of seven individual jurors. A National Jury Result stays valid as long as there are at least three results of individual jury members.

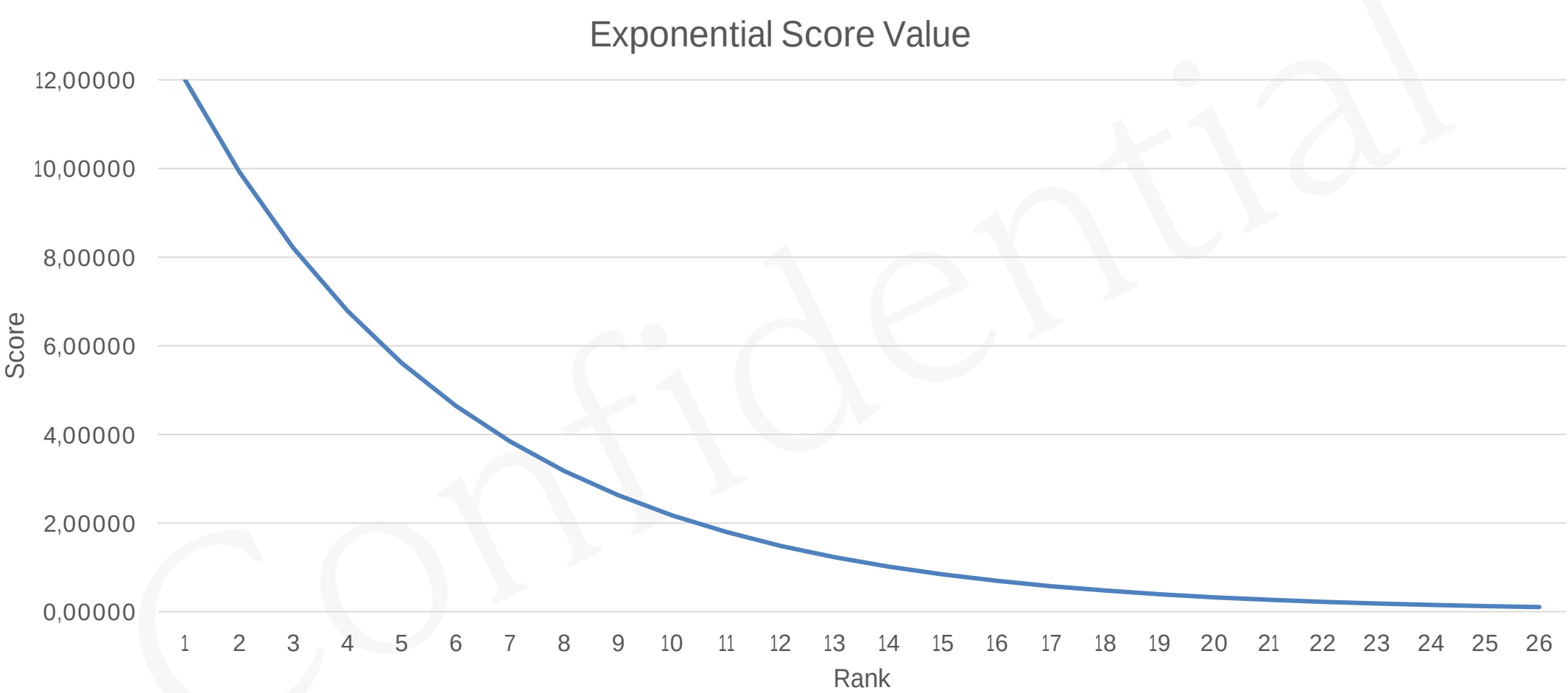
On the basis of the results entered, the ESC voting web interface will automatically calculate the final national rank of each song by converting the individual ranking allocated by each Jury Member into a specific score value.

This is done to minimize the impact of individual jurors, political or strategic voting.

1.3 JURY VOTING

The ranks of each jury member are transformed via the following exponential function:

Rank	Score (fix)
1	12
2	9,92351
3	8,20634
4	6,78631
5	5,612
6	4,64089
7	3,83783
8	3,17373
9	2,62454
10	2,17039
11	1,79482
12	1,48425
13	1,22741
14	1,01502
15	0,83938
16	0,69413
17	0,57402
18	0,47469
19	0,39255
20	0,32462
21	0,26845
22	0,222
23	0,18358
24	0,15181
25	0,12554
26	0,10382



1.3 JURY VOTING

A score value of 12 points shall be allocated to the best ranked song; each song subsequently ranked shall be allocated a score value which decreases exponentially.

The sum of each juror's score determines the final ranking of the national Jury. The highest sum is ranked best (1), the second highest sum (2), and so on.

Rank	Score (fix)
1	12
2	9,92351
3	8,20634
4	6,78631
5	5,612
6	4,64089
7	3,83783
8	3,17373
9	2,62454
10	2,17039
11	1,79482
12	1,48425
13	1,22741
14	1,01502
15	0,83938
16	0,69413
17	0,57402
18	0,47469
19	0,39255
20	0,32462
21	0,26845
22	0,222
23	0,18358
24	0,15181
25	0,12554
26	0,10382

DDI	Country	Juror 1	Juror 2	Juror 3	Juror 4	Juror 5	Juror 6	Juror 7	SUM after exponential scoring (ILLUSTRATION ONLY, WILL NOT BE SHOWN IN THE WEB INTERFACE)	Ranks after exponential scoring	Points of National Jury
1	Cyprus	19	24	14	3	2	12	24	21,32529	10	1
2	Moldova	14	18	9	1	4	1	25	35,0261	1	12
3	San Marino	5	7	7	6	15	7	2	32,52927	2	10
4	Latvia	25	14	24	13	6	17	14	8,74971	22	0
5	Czechia	20	23	8	9	26	14	12	8,90956	21	0
6	Lithuania	13	15	15	16	1	19	17	16,56687	17	0
7	Malta	17	2	19	10	7	8	26	20,17585	12	0
8	Romania	9	12	20	23	25	22	16	5,65866	25	0
9	Greece	1	22	22	18	22	3	21	21,61548	9	2
10	Portugal	11	8	13	24	21	23	11	8,59462	24	0
11	Germany	10	21	21	19	14	24	20	4,59129	26	0
12	Italy	8	5	4	11	11	21	15	20,26951	11	0
13	France	12	10	11	2	17	18	13	17,64909	14	0
14	Austria	16	20	10	7	20	5	8	16,13732	19	0
15	United Kingdom	3	4	17	17	3	16	6	29,68205	4	7
16	Albania	6	19	16	20	24	10	22	8,59639	23	0
17	Bulgaria	26	16	12	21	16	26	3	11,55494	20	0
18	Croatia	7	26	6	12	23	13	5	17,08978	16	0
19	Montenegro	15	25	2	4	13	11	10	22,86736	6	5
20	Switzerland	18	9	5	22	9	4	1	30,34408	3	8
21	Serbia	2	11	23	8	19	25	4	22,38004	7	4
22	Australia	22	13	3	5	5	15	23	21,90271	8	3
23	Denmark	24	1	18	25	18	20	9	16,17589	18	0
24	Estonia	4	17	25	14	8	6	7	20,15334	13	0
25	Finland	21	3	1	15	12	9	18	25,89765	5	6
26	Norway	23	6	26	26	10	2	19	17,51856	15	0

1.3 JURY VOTING

In both Semi-Finals and in the Final, only the ten best ranked songs by the respective National Jury will be considered and

- (1) 12 points shall be allocated to the song having obtained the highest rank (1) from the National Jury ;
- (2) 10 points to the song having obtained the second-best (2) rank from the National Jury ,
- (3) 8 points to the song having obtained the third-best (3) final rank from the National Jury ,
- (4) 7 points to the next,
- (5) and so on, down to 1 point for the song having obtained the tenth-best rank (10) from the National Jury.

1.3.1 TIE SITUATIONS

TIE DUE TO THE SAME NUMBER OF POINTS FROM ALL NATIONAL JURIES

Should there be a tie, because two songs have received the same number of points from all the National Juries, the winner shall be the song which

- has obtained points from the highest number of National Juries.
- If the tying songs have received points from the same number of National Juries, the highest number of 12-point scores shall be decisive.
- If the winner still cannot be determined by this procedure, the number of times ten points have been awarded shall be the deciding factor.

If necessary, this method shall continue until account has been taken of the number of times one point has been awarded. In the very unlikely case that after applying the above procedure there is still a tie, the tie shall be resolved by giving precedence to the country which was earlier in the running order for the Show concerned.

1.3.1 TIE SITUATIONS

TIE DUE TO THE SAME RANK FROM THE NATIONAL JURY IN A GIVEN COUNTRY

Should two or more songs receive exactly the same rank from a National Jury, the order shall be automatically ascertained by the Jury Web Interface by comparing the individual ranks between the respective songs allocated by the Jurors. The song which is received better rankings by a majority of the jurors wins the tie.

If there is still a tie after the automatic calculation, the final order shall be decided by the vote of the youngest member of the Jury. In case there are two youngest Jurors with the same date of birth, the Chairperson will ask the entire jury by a show of hands what the order of the tied songs shall be.

1.4 SCORE CALCULATION SEMI-FINALS

The Grand Final qualifiers are determined by the combined result of the Audience voting (Call, SMS, and Paid Online Voting) and the result of the National Juries.

The results of the national juries and audiences from the participating countries will be converted into the 12-point system separately by the voting partner under the supervision of the EBU and of the Independent Voting Observer. Each participating country will award 58 points from the National Jury (1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10, and 12) and 58 points from the National Audience (1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10, and 12), meaning that each country awards a total of 116 points.

In addition, the RoW Audience will award a total of 58 points (1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10, and 12).

The points of the National Juries, the National Audiences, and the RoW Audiences shall be combined according to a ratio which is determined by the EBU, subject to the Reference Group approval.

In the first Semi Final the 17 national audiences award 986 points and the RoW Audiences will award 58 points. A total of 1.044 points (51,4%), while the 17 national juries will award 986 points (48,6%).

In the second Semi Final the 18 national audiences award 1.044 points and the RoW Audiences will award 58 points. A total of 1.102 points (51,4%), while the 18 national juries will award 1.044 points (48,6%).

1.5 SCORE CALCULATION GRAND FINAL

The winner of the Eurovision Song Contest is determined by the combined result of the Audience voting (Call, SMS, and Paid Online Voting) and the result of the National Juries.

The results of the national juries and audiences from the participating countries will be converted into the 12-point system separately by the voting partner under the supervision of the EBU and of the Independent Voting Observer. Each participating country will award 58 points from the National Jury (1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10, and 12) and 58 points from the National Audience (1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10, and 12), meaning that each country awards a total of 116 points.

In addition, the RoW Audience will award a total of 58 points (1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 10, and 12).

The points of the National Juries, the National Audiences, and the RoW Audiences shall be combined according to a ratio which is determined by the EBU, subject to the Reference Group approval.

At the Eurovision Song Contest 2026 the 35 national and the RoW Audiences will award in the Grand Final a total of 2.088 points (50.7 %) while the 35 National Juries award a total of 2.030 points (49,3%).

1.6 SCORE CALCULATION – SAN MARINO

Due to its size and the fact that National Audience votes can not be correctly allocated in its entirety. No audience vote is conducted in the Republic of San Marino.

The EBU requests the following arrangement to calculate the audience result in San Marino or any other country where Audience Voting shall not be possible:

The national audience result shall be calculated automatically on the basis of the result of a pre-selected group of countries (see chapter 3.2. Pots). If such aggregated result is not available, it will be replaced by the results of the combined National Jury of the country concerned. – Voting Instructions 2.5.3 (a)(ii).

The other part of the official result shall be calculated by the national Jury of San Marino.

It must be avoided that any national Jury will award 116 points (58 points for the Audience result and 58 points from a National Jury) .

1.7 TIE SITUATIONS – COMBINED RESULT

In case of a tie in the combined Jury and Audience result, due to two or more songs having received the same number of points, the winner shall be the song which has obtained the highest rank from all the National Audiences and the RoW voting.

Due to paragraph 1.2.1. the audience rank is unambiguous and would solve all tie situations in the combined result.

All other tie situations are solved according to paragraph 1.2.1. (Audience voting) and paragraph 1.3.1. (jury voting) respectively.

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2. RESULT PRESENTATION

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2.1 RESULTS PRESENTATION IN THE SEMIFINALS

- The 10 countries qualified for the Grand-Final will be revealed by the hosts of the show.
- The announcing order will be decided by the EBU Executive Producer.

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2.2 GRAND FINAL - ANNOUNCEMENT OF THE POINTS

1. The announcement of the Jury points in the Grand Final will start directly after the voting window has ended (Direct link between voting and result)
 - Pays tribute to the fact that most of the big voting countries do not show commercials
 - Takes advantage of the fact that more time available to collect results
 - Keeps the audience connected to the show even during the commercial break – no emotional pause
 - Longer voting promotion.
2. The spokespersons from each PBs will read out only the official verified result of the national juries and only the 12 points.
3. The presentation of the Audience result will follow once all the jury results have been announced by the spokespersons
4. The host of the show will announce the result of the Audience, which includes the national result of the participating countries and the 58 points awarded by the RoW audience.
5. The Audience result is not presented on a national level but rather the sum of points an artist has received from all audiences will be revealed

The EBU Executive Producer may determine the order of announcement after consultation with ONCE and the host broadcaster.

2.3 PRESENTING THE AUDIENCE RESULT

1. Before the Audience result is revealed the complete result of the jury appears on the score board
2. ONCE will verify all audience results and deliver it to the EBU and the host broadcaster simultaneously.
3. The Independent Voting Observer of the EBU will oversee the voting and be present during the live show.
4. The announcement of the Audience result will start with the country that received the fewest jury points and end with the country that received the highest jury points.
5. ONCE will make the respective national audience result available to the PBs shortly before the announcement of the Audience result will begin.
 - a. It is **mandatory** for all the national PB to announce the national audience result during the LIVE show.
 - b. The EBU will reveal the national jury, the audience and the RoW Voting result for all shows on eurovision.com after the end of the Grand Final of the Eurovision Song Contest
 - c. ONCE will send the necessary data to the respective partner of the EBU

3. POT SYSTEM AND FALLBACK SCENARIOS

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3.1 INFORMATION ABOUT THE POT SYSTEM

- § The system was implemented in 2008 to allocate countries to the two Semi-Finals
- § For 2026, countries are allocated into five (5) different pots with a max. amount of six countries per pot. The number of pots and the number of countries allocated in the pots depend on the number of participants and the number of pre-qualified countries each year.
- § The results of the centralized voting since 2004 (Semi-Finals results only until 2007) are taken into account to determine voting patterns and allocate countries with “friendly” voting behavior towards each other into one pot, thereby separating half of the respective countries into the two Semi-Finals.
- § A master pot “Pot zero (0)” consists of the pre-qualified countries, the so-called BIG 4 (France, Germany, Italy and the United Kingdom) as well as the host/winner country.
- § In the event, that only one or no country delivers a valid Audience or Jury result, the Master pot (Pot 0) is added to the remaining country in the respective pot, to create the substitute result.
- § The pots are confirmed by the EBU and the Reference Group of the Eurovision Song Contest prior to the allocation draw.

3.2 ESC 2026 - POTS

Eurovision Song Contest 2026, 16.05.2026

Pot 1	Pot 2	Pot 3	Pot 4	Pot 5	Pot 6
Albania AL	Australia AU	Armenia AM	Belgium BE	Cyprus CY	
Bulgaria BG	Denmark DK	Azerbaijan AZ	Czechia CZ	Greece GR	
Croatia HR	Estonia EE	Georgia GE	Luxembourg LU	Latvia LV	
Montenegro ME	Finland FI	Israel IL	Moldova MD	Lithuania LT	
Serbia RS	Norway NO	Poland PL	Portugal PT	Malta MT	
Switzerland CH	Sweden SE	Ukraine UA	Romania RO	San Marino SM	

In the Semi Final only three pots are generated in order to have a sufficient number of countries allocated to the respective pots:

Semi Final 1

Pot 1	Pot 2	Pot 3
Croatia HR	Belgium BE	Estonia EE
Finland FI	Georgia GE	Greece GR
Montenegro ME	Israel IL	Lithuania LT
Serbia RS	Moldova MD	Portugal PT
Sweden SE	Poland PL	San Marino SM

Semi Final 2

Pot 1	Pot 2	Pot 3
Albania AL	Armenia AM	Bulgaria BG
Australia AU	Azerbaijan AZ	Cyprus CY
Denmark DK	Luxembourg LU	Czechia CZ
Norway NO	Romania RO	Latvia LV
Switzerland CH	Ukraine UA	Malta MT

Pre-Qualified Countries

Pot 0
Austria AT SF2
France FR SF2
Germany DE SF1
Italy IT SF1
Rest of World RoW SF1+SF2
United Kingdom GB SF2

The RoW is not considered when calculation substation results.

3.2 FALLBACK SCENARIOS

- 1) The Audience Pot System is used in the event, that
 - the voting threshold (not enough call, SMS or paid online votes) in a participating country has not been reached. The calculated Pot-votes are added to the valid votes of the country in question until the threshold is reached;
 - no votes have been received due to technical problems. The entire audience result of the the respective country is calculated by Pot-votes;
 - no Audience voting was implemented (e.g. San Marino). The entire audience result of the the respective country is calculated by the Pot-votes.
- 2) The Jury Pot System is used in the event, that
 - no valid Audience result in the respective country could be generated, in order to act as a backup for point 1 above;
 - a National Jury Result has been disqualified by the EBU;
 - an insufficient number of jurors participated in the national jury voting procedure;
 - and a tie between two or more songs in the National Audience voting or the RoW voting, having received the same number of votes, needs to be solved and no valid national jury voting result is available.
- 3) The national jury result shall only be used as a backup for the audience vote in the participating countries if no Audience Pot-Result (point 2) could be generated or the number of countries without valid audience voting result is too high and the ESC Executive Producer deems the result not representative of the audience.
- 4) In case of technical problems with the RoW voting or an insufficient number of votes has been cast, the RoW result will be calculated based on the televoting result of Pot 0 (The pot of the Big 5, HB and the winner).

4. JURY VOTING

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4.1 USAGE OF THE JURY VOTE

“Votes of the National Juries” – ESC Voting Instructions

“The votes of the National Juries shall be used (i) for calculating the ranking of the songs and (ii) in case of a technical or similar failure in the audience voting procedure, or (iii) to solve a tie situation should two or more songs receive the same number of votes from the National Audience;

The EBU shall decide during the Semi-Finals and the Final whether only the National Jury votes shall be used.”

The fallback scenarios are stipulated in Point 3.2.

- Using the national jury result as a backup solution in case of technical or similar failure in the audience voting procedure would increase the power of the national jury. A national jury would allocate 58 country points twice (first for the regular jury result and second as a substitute for the audience result).
- To clarify: technical or similar failure in the audience voting procedure refers to a general technical failure of the audience voting and a POT result would not be suitable anymore.)

4.2 IRREGULARITIES IN JURY VOTING

Process

- Jury Results are screened after all national Juries have confirmed their results
- 6-eye principle
- Supervised by the CEO of ONCE
- Monitored and acknowledged by the Independent Voting Observer of the Eurovision Song Contest

Indicators

1. *Deviation from the norm*
Does the result reflect the overall taste of the other professional jurors?
2. *Voting Patterns*
Are there visible patterns of voting within the jurors?
3. *Irregularities*
Did the juries observe the rules of the Eurovision Song Contest?
4. *Reoccurring Patterns*
Do other countries repeat similar voting patterns?
5. *Are there beneficiaries*
If deviations occur, who benefits from the result?

VOTING ELIMINATION IN A COUNTRY – JURY VOTING

The EBU is entitled to eliminate the result of the national jury in a country, if

1. The composition of the jury does not reflect the instructions set in the rules or the EBU voting instructions.
2. The jury voting result is erroneous or incomplete (e.g. an error is reported by an authenticated notary of a broadcaster. In this case the pan-European voting partner will try to correct the error as quickly as possible based on the corrected result provided by the notary. Otherwise, the erroneous or incomplete voting result will be eliminated.)
3. In a comparative and absolute assessment of the voting results stemming from all jury members of the respective country, the result is deemed to have the intent to force a certain final result by uniformly voting for multiple contestants
4. Less than three results of jury members of a national jury were received by the jury web interface or transmitted by the participating.

The disqualification of a jury result by the EBU shall ensure the idea of free, independent and professional voting by the selected representatives of each national jury. *If it appears that votes of a national jury are cast only in the intent to abuse the voting system or to false the final results or have not been undertaken in accordance with the Voting Instructions, the EBU, in consultation with the Pan-European voting partner, the Independent Voting Observer of the voting process and the chairman of the Reference Group reserve the right to remove such votes for allocating the ranks.*

4.3 HANDLING OF IRREGULARITIES IN JURY VOTING

Substitute by Jury Pot-Result

An invalid jury result in the respective country will be calculated automatically by using the average of the exponential ranking per song from each valid juror of the countries in the respective pot of the disqualified country.

Ranking the own song is not allowed (home vote), thereof a rank of 0 will not be considered in the average calculation.

In the unlikely event that only one valid national jury result is available in the respective pot, the rank for each song will be calculated by the remaining valid jury member results of the pot and the valid jury member results from the countries of Pot 0 (pre-qualified countries).

Reference: Chapter 2.4.2 Voting Instructions

CALCULATION OF SUBSTITUTE RESULT BY USING THE POT SYSTEM

To substitute a disqualified national jury result, the result of the national jury in question shall be calculated by using the individual results of all jury members from the countries in the same Pot as the disqualified country.

Process

1. The countries in the respective pot of the disqualified jury will be used to calculate the substitute result.
2. Each juror rank per song in each country will be used to calculate the substitute result.
3. For each rank the exponential weighting will be assigned.
4. The average of all exponentially weighted ranks will be calculated. (Zero values will not influence this average calculation.)
5. Based on the average exponential values the final ranks will be allocated to each song.
6. Based on these ranks the points from 1 – 8, 10 , and 12 will be allocated:
 - (1) 12 points shall be allocated to the song having obtained the highest rank (1) from the Pot-Jury Calculation,
 - (2) 10 points to the song having obtained the second-best (2) rank from the Pot-Jury Calculation,
 - (3) 8 points to the song having obtained the third-best (3) final rank from the Pot-Jury Calculation,
 - (4) 7 points to the next,
 - (5) and so on, down to 1 point for the song having obtained the tenth-best rank (10) from the Pot-Jury Calculation .

4.3.1 TIE SITUATION IN CALCULATED SUBSTITUTE JURY RESULT

In case of a tie between two or more countries in the Jury Pot calculation (Paragraph 4.3 (b)), meaning the tying songs have the same average score, the winner shall be the song that

- has the highest number of 1-rank scores shall be decisive.
- If the winner still cannot be determined by this procedure, the number of times 2-rank scores shall be the deciding factor.
- If necessary, this method shall continue until account has been taken of the number of times the lowest rank has been awarded.

In the very unlikely case that after applying the above procedure the tie shall be resolved by giving precedence to the song which was earlier in the running order for the Show concerned.

EXAMPLE SWEDEN 2019

DDI	Countries	Denmark					Estonia			Norway			Average	Rank	Original SE	
		Juror 1	Juror 2	Juror 3	Juror 4	Juror 5	Juror 1	Juror 2	Juror 3	Juror 3	Juror 4	Juror 5			Points	Result
1	Malta	24	13	22	15	10	21		17	13	7	13	1,7744338	16	0	0
2	Albania	25	14	11	21	23	23		23	23	23	19	0,3761275	26	0	0
3	Czech Republic	4	18	9	16	5	6		10	2	3	3	5,4726708	3	10	7
4	Germany	9	3	7	2	11	15		16	21	17	15	1,9511913	14	0	0
5	Russia	11	2	18	7	6	5		6	8	16	12	2,7092850	10	2	3
6	Denmark	0	0	0	0	0	2		13	4	4	9	2,7129326	9	3	2
7	San Marino	7	24	23	8	13	20		25	24	25	24	0,6161838	23	0	0
8	North Macedonia	3	7	3	4	9	17		18	1	2	2	5,1248217	4	8	10
9	Sweden	1	1	12	3	1	3		1	5	1	5	9,4735804	1	0	0
10	Slovenia	17	22	2	23	24	11		19	22	21	14	1,9258463	15	0	0
11	Cyprus	12	23	17	22	19	10		20	14	5	20	1,2855404	20	0	0
12	Netherlands	14	5	4	9	2	7		5	10	12	4	5,7957688	2	12	12
13	Greece	23	25	25	24	25	18		22	25	24	22	0,5785896	24	0	0
14	Israel	21	16	14	10	21	24		21	17	20	17	0,6163746	22	0	0
15	Norway	5	11	19	1	7	22		14	0	0	0	2,5182095	11	1	0
16	United Kingdom	10	10	16	5	12	19		15	7	8	6	1,6389933	18	0	0
17	Iceland	19	21	8	25	20	14		11	11	22	25	1,5681579	19	0	0
18	Estonia	2	8	10	11	8	0		0	20	11	11	2,4239275	12	0	1
19	Belarus	20	20	20	20	18	16		12	18	15	16	0,8296171	21	0	0
20	Azerbaijan	13	6	5	12	3	13		2	6	14	7	4,2797296	7	5	6
21	France	22	17	6	17	15	9		8	15	18	23	1,6571125	17	0	0
22	Italy	8	9	1	18	16	12		7	16	13	1	3,1788596	8	4	5
23	Serbia	16	12	15	19	22	4		9	12	10	18	1,9616154	13	0	0
24	Switzerland	6	4	13	6	4	1		4	3	6	8	4,9524471	5	7	8
25	Australia	18	15	21	13	17	25		3	9	9	10	4,6727308	6	6	4
26	Spain	15	19	24	14	14	8		24	19	19	21	0,4952013	25	0	0

à By including the ranks of each juror of the respective countries in the pot, the result are changing and the effects of political voting is reduced.

Note: Sweden can't award points to themselves, therefore Netherlands with rank 2 receives 12 points.

5. AUDIENCE VOTING

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5.1 VOTING WINDOWS

- Semi Finals:
 - The voting window for National Audiences in each Semi Final opens after the last performance and closes 15-25 minutes later depending on the running order of the Shows.
- Grand-Final:
 - The voting window for National Audiences in the Grand-Final opens before the start of the first performance in the live Grand-Final and closes approximately 25-40 minutes after the end of the last performance, depending on the running order of the Grand-Final. The exact duration is under discretion of the Host Broadcaster after approval of the ESC Executive supervisor.

5.2 USAGE OF THE AUDIENCE VOTE

The votes of the National Audiences shall be used

- for calculating the ranking of the songs in the Semi-Final and Grand Final

Irregularities in audience voting arise due to different failures and problems which are listed on the following slides.

ONCE implemented two systems that detect attempts to manipulate the voting:

1. Automatic fraud detection
2. Manual fraud detection.

In the following, the individual cases of detection of problems and failures and the handling of those are listed and explained.

5.3 AUTOMATIC HANDLING OF IRREGULARITIES

Technical or similar failures in the audience voting are defined as

1. A country misses the voting threshold either by
 - a) generating too few votes by the audience
 - b) the elimination of fraudulent votes reduces the vote volume below the voting threshold
 - c) The voting result is erroneous or incomplete
2. A country does not deliver any votes to the centralized voting platform because of
 - a) technical failure in the connection or platform of the T-Partner, national carrier or Pan-European voting partner
 - b) the disqualification of the entire result due to Prohibited Mass Voting which cannot be eliminated by other security measures
 - c) in a comparative and absolute assessment of the voting results stemming from the various sources, one or more sources are deemed to be influenced by mass voting as defined above
 - d) lack of implementation of audience voting in a respective country (e.g. San Marino)

In the above-mentioned cases the national audience result for the respective country will be calculated by using the average and equalized number of votes per song from the valid audience results of the other countries in the respective pot.

In its elimination of votes, the EBU shall minimize the influence of mass voting but maximize the influence of votes cast in good faith. The goal is to use as many valid votes as possible from the respective country.

Only the number of votes necessary to reach the voting threshold will be added to the valid votes of the respective country.

BELOW VOTING THRESHOLD

Votes							
DDI	Country	Armenia	Azerbaijan	Belarus	Russia	Ukraine (*)	Georgia
DDI01	Slovenia	73	135	600	4.107	569	28
DDI02	France	346	24	151	1.112	686	16
DDI03	Israel	281	476	762	5.772	1.953	56
DDI04	Estonia	437	417	4.073	16.465	1.490	167
DDI05	UnitedKingdom	48	61	173	1.169	1.008	36
DDI06	Armenia	0	8	929	19.899	971	951
DDI07	Lithuania	42	87	382	1.694	913	78
DDI08	Serbia	109	49	522	8.520	846	51
DDI09	Norway	92	119	534	2.341	920	17
DDI10	Sweden	537	755	3.366	13.795	3.913	138
DDI11	Cyprus	81	53	208	2.468	755	17
DDI12	Australia	248	321	1.119	5.036	2.979	33
DDI13	Belgium	397	333	4.017	19.667	1.978	117
DDI14	Austria	43	36	161	968	458	15
DDI15	Greece	267	110	238	3.786	378	67
DDI16	Montenegro	889	143	412	4.908	389	24
DDI17	Germany	73	95	404	1.956	835	34
DDI18	Poland	75	105	483	2.992	858	32
DDI19	Latvia	126	351	2.550	13.769	1.502	205
DDI20	Romania	82	32	499	3.699	4.263	32
DDI21	Ukraine (*)	187	230	576	5.095	0	26
DDI22	Hungary	44	57	343	2.900	489	13
DDI23	Georgia	531	604	1.877	13.464	1.528	0
DDI24	Azerbaijan	22	0	846	9.598	273	454
DDI25	Russia	2.300	1.602	29.999	0	2.782	460
DDI26	Albania	68	213	214	1.187	618	19
DDI27	Italy	1.615	985	3.948	33.427	7.772	284
Sum		9.013	7.401	59.386	199.794	41.126	3.370

Equalizing the votes								Georgia			Points			
Armenia		Azerbaijan		Belarus	Russia	Ukraine (*)	Average	Necessary to reach threshold	New Sum	Old Rank	New Rank	based on original votes		New
27		61		34	69	47	48	23	51	18	20	0		0
129		11		9	19	56	45	22	38	24	23	0		0
105		217		43	97	160	124	60	116	11	9	0		2
163		190		231	278	122	197	95	262	6	6	5		5
18		28		10	20	83	32	16	52	13	19	0		0
0		4		53	336	80	118	57	1.008	1	1	12		12
16		40		22	29	75	36	18	96	9	10	2		1
41		22		30	144	69	61	30	81	12	13	0		0
34		54		30	39	75	47	23	40	22	21	0		0
201		344		191	233	321	258	124	262	7	6	4		5
30		24		12	42	62	34	17	34	22	24	0		0
93		146		64	85	244	126	61	94	15	11	0		0
148		152		228	332	162	204	98	215	8	8	3		3
16		16		9	16	38	19	10	25	25	26	0		0
100		50		14	64	31	52	25	92	10	12	1		0
332		65		23	83	32	107	52	76	20	15	0		0
27		43		23	33	68	39	19	53	14	18	0		0
28		48		27	50	70	45	22	54	16	17	0		0
47		160		145	232	123	141	68	273	5	5	6		6
31		15		28	62	349	97	47	79	16	14	0		0
70		105		33	86	0	73	36	62	19	16	0		0
16		26		19	49	40	30	15	28	26	25	0		0
199		275		107	227	125	0	0	0	27	27	0		0
8		0		48	162	22	60	29	483	3	4	8		7
860		729		1.702	0	228	880	421	881	2	2	10		10
25		97		12	20	51	41	20	39	21	22	0		0
604		449		224	564	637	495	237	521	4	3	7		8
Equalizing Factor for each country														
2,674480712		2,196142433		17,62195846	59,28605341	12,20356083	3.410	1.630	5.015					
Multiplication factor to reach threshold: 0,47803722							Voting threshold	5.000						

NO VOTES DELIVERED

Votes							
DDI	Country	Armenia	Azerbaijan	Belarus	Russia	Ukraine (*)	Georgia
DDI01	Slovenia	73	135	600	4.107	569	
DDI02	France	346	24	151	1.112	686	
DDI03	Israel	281	476	762	5.772	1.953	
DDI04	Estonia	437	417	4.073	16.465	1.490	
DDI05	UnitedKingdom	48	61	173	1.169	1.008	
DDI06	Armenia	0	8	929	19.899	971	
DDI07	Lithuania	42	87	382	1.694	913	
DDI08	Serbia	109	49	522	8.520	846	
DDI09	Norway	92	119	534	2.341	920	
DDI10	Sweden	537	755	3.366	13.795	3.913	
DDI11	Cyprus	81	53	208	2.468	755	
DDI12	Australia	248	321	1.119	5.036	2.979	
DDI13	Belgium	397	333	4.017	19.667	1.978	
DDI14	Austria	43	36	161	968	458	
DDI15	Greece	267	110	238	3.786	378	
DDI16	Montenegro	889	143	412	4.908	389	
DDI17	Germany	73	95	404	1.956	835	
DDI18	Poland	75	105	483	2.992	858	
DDI19	Latvia	126	351	2.550	13.769	1.502	
DDI20	Romania	82	32	499	3.699	4.263	
DDI21	Ukraine (*)	187	230	576	5.095	0	
DDI22	Hungary	44	57	343	2.900	489	
DDI23	Georgia	531	604	1.877	13.464	1.528	
DDI24	Azerbaijan	22	0	846	9.598	273	
DDI25	Russia	2.300	1.602	29.999	0	2.782	
DDI26	Albania	68	213	214	1.187	618	
DDI27	Italy	1.615	985	3.948	33.427	7.772	
Sum		9.013	7.401	59.386	199.794	41.126	0

Equalizing the votes					Average	Necessary to reach threshold	Georgia		Points		
Armenia	Azerbaijan	Belarus	Russia	Ukraine (*)			New Sum	Old Rank	New Rank	based on original votes	New
0,0080994	0,0182408	0,0101034	0,0205562	0,0138355	0	71	71	#NV	16	#NV	0
0,0383890	0,0032428	0,0025427	0,0055657	0,0166804	0	67	67	#NV	18	#NV	0
0,0311772	0,0643156	0,0128313	0,0288898	0,0474882	0	185	185	#NV	8	#NV	3
0,0484855	0,0563437	0,0685852	0,0824099	0,0362301	0	293	293	#NV	5	#NV	6
0,0053256	0,0082421	0,0029131	0,0058510	0,0245100	0	47	47	#NV	24	#NV	0
0,0000000	0,0010809	0,0156434	0,0995976	0,0236104	0	175	175	#NV	9	#NV	2
0,0046599	0,0117552	0,0064325	0,0084787	0,0222001	0	54	54	#NV	22	#NV	0
0,0120936	0,0066207	0,0087900	0,0426439	0,0205709	0	91	91	#NV	13	#NV	0
0,0102075	0,0160789	0,0089920	0,0117171	0,0223703	0	70	70	#NV	17	#NV	0
0,0595806	0,1020132	0,0566800	0,0690461	0,0951466	0	383	383	#NV	3	#NV	8
0,0089870	0,0071612	0,0035025	0,0123527	0,0183582	0	51	51	#NV	23	#NV	0
0,0275158	0,0433725	0,0188428	0,0252060	0,0724359	0	188	188	#NV	7	#NV	4
0,0440475	0,0449939	0,0676422	0,0984364	0,0480961	0	304	304	#NV	4	#NV	7
0,0047709	0,0048642	0,0027111	0,0048450	0,0111365	0	29	29	#NV	26	#NV	0
0,0296239	0,0148629	0,0040077	0,0189495	0,0091913	0	77	77	#NV	15	#NV	0
0,0986353	0,0193217	0,0069377	0,0245653	0,0094587	0	159	159	#NV	10	#NV	1
0,0080994	0,0128361	0,0068030	0,0097901	0,0203035	0	58	58	#NV	21	#NV	0
0,0083213	0,0141873	0,0081332	0,0149754	0,0208627	0	67	67	#NV	18	#NV	0
0,0139798	0,0474260	0,0429394	0,0689160	0,0365219	0	210	210	#NV	6	#NV	5
0,0090980	0,0043237	0,0084027	0,0185141	0,1036571	0	144	144	#NV	11	#NV	0
0,0207478	0,0310769	0,0096993	0,0255013	0,0000000	0	109	109	#NV	12	#NV	0
0,0048818	0,0077017	0,0057758	0,0145150	0,0118903	0	45	45	#NV	25	#NV	0
0,0589149	0,0816106	0,0316068	0,0673894	0,0371541	0	0	0	#NV	27	#NV	0
0,0024409	0,0000000	0,0142458	0,0480395	0,0066381	0	90	90	#NV	14	#NV	0
0,2551870	0,2164572	0,5051527	0,0000000	0,0676458	0	1.306	1.306	#NV	1	#NV	12
0,0075447	0,0287799	0,0036035	0,0059411	0,0150270	0	61	61	#NV	20	#NV	0
0,1791856	0,1330901	0,0664803	0,1673073	0,1889802	0	736	736	#NV	2	#NV	10
Equalizing Factor for each country											
9013	7401	59386	199794	41126	1	5.000	5.070				
Multiplication factor to reach threshold: 5000					Voting threshold	5.000					

RULES FOR IMPLEMENTING THE POT-CALCULATION IN THE AUDIENCE VOTING

- 1) If a country, after the automated and manual fraud inspection, still has enough votes to reach the voting limit, the Audience result is ranked according to the amount of votes each song has received.
- 2) If no or one country in Pot 0 (Big 4 + HB) is above the voting limit or deliver no valid voting result at all (hence both cases are summarized under the declaration “below the voting limit”), the national jury result is used for the respective countries from Pot 0.
- 3) In order to generate a supplemented result by using the POT calculation, at least two (2) countries must deliver a valid audience/jury result after the automated and manual fraud inspection.
- 4) If there are at least two (2) countries of a single pot (1-5) ABOVE the voting limit, the Pot calculation is used. The POT-supplemented result is calculated with the valid results from the countries allocated in the same Pot plus the valid votes of the respective country below the voting limit. (For the avoidance of doubt, the jury result for countries in Pot 1-5 is NOT used in such an event. Only for the countries in the POT 0 the “Rule 2” above does apply.)
- 5) If there is only one country above the voting limit (POT 1-5) AND in Pot 0 ONE (1) country is ABOVE the voting limit then the supplemented result in the respective Pot is calculated by the one remaining country of the respective Pot and one remaining country of Pot 0. BUT for all other countries in the POT 0 the “Rule 2” above does apply.
Example: in Pot 3 only Armenia and in Pot 0 only Germany is ABOVE the voting limit. This means that the Pot calculation is used for the other countries from Pot 3: Azerbaijan, Belarus, Georgia, Moldova, Russia and Ukraine with the results from Armenia and Germany. For the other countries from Pot 0: France, Italy, Spain, HB and United Kingdom the respective national jury result is used.
- 6) If only one country is above the voting limit AND all countries from Pot 0 are BELOW the voting limit then the respective national jury result of all countries below the voting limit is used for all countries of the respective Pot and Rule number 2 is active (Jury results are used for Pot 0 due to the fact that there is no valid audience result available for each country).
- 7) If all countries in a single POT (1 – 5) are BELOW the voting limit AND in Pot 0 at least TWO (2) countries are ABOVE the voting limit then the supplemented result in the respective Pot is calculated by the countries with the valid voting result from Pot 0. BUT the EBU supervisor may still order that the national jury results from the respective countries will be used instead of the Pot calculation.
- 8) To increase the number of countries from which a supplemented result is calculated in the Semi Finals, the respective countries from the five Pots are joint to three Pots for each Semi Final. Therefore only 3 Pots + Pot 0 are used in each Semi Final.

PROHIBITED MASS VOTING

It is not allowed to contribute to the audience voting by

1. Surpassing the allowed maximum number of 10 votes from one single terminal (telephone, mobile phone or other)
2. Engage in any mass voting that aim at giving advantage to a single entry assisted by use in two or more countries in parallel of
 - a) devices other than consumers' terminals,
 - b) call centers,
 - c) mobile marketing and phone service providers,
 - d) corporate phone systems
 - e) abnormal purchase of SIM-cards or
 - f) any other comparable means

DETECTION OF INCONSISTENT NATIONAL AUDIENCE RESULTS AUTOMATED IDENTIFICATION AND HANDLING

In countries where the pan-European voting partner is able to clearly identify a user (e.g. by means of the MSISDN) from a single T-Partner, the voting pattern for the starting order of the songs (DDIs) is generated and automatically analyzed.

The system will accept the result of a specific DDI in the event that

1. Historic results or Diaspora explain voting peaks
2. The number of users that casted four and more votes for the specific DDI (M-User) are
 - a) lower than the average amount of M-User in the respective country, or
 - b) less than a predefined minimum values of allowed M-User
(such value being necessary in countries with a low voting participation) .

In all other cases the system will analyze the voting pattern according to the following rules.

DETECTION OF INCONSISTENT NATIONAL AUDIENCE RESULTS AUTOMATED IDENTIFICATION AND HANDLING

If the audience result of a DDI is not automatically accepted the voting pattern is analyzed and proportionately recalculated, if

1. The total amount of votes for the respective DDI is aggregated by **more than the acceptable predefined M-User percentage** from Users that casted four and more votes for the specific DDI (M-Users) and
the percentage of a single M-User Group (e.g. user that voted four times for a specific DDI are aggregated in the “M-User Group 4x”, user that voted five times for a specific DDI are aggregated in the “M-User Group 5x”, etc.) that voted for the respective DDI is higher than the percentage of user that voted only one, two or three times (R-User) for the respective DDI.
2. The total amount of votes for the respective DDI is aggregated by **less than the acceptable predefined M-User percentage** from User that casted four and more votes for the specific DDI (M-Users) and
 - a) The percentage of a single M-User Group that voted for the respective DDI is higher than the total percentage of M-User in the respective country, and
 - b) The total amount of votes by a single M-User Group is higher than the proportional value of votes from the R-User in respect to the total percentage of M-User in the respective country, and
 - c) The total amount of votes by a single M-User Group is higher than the proportional value of votes from the R-User in respect to the percentage of R-User voting for the specific DDI from the total amount of R-User in respective country.

5.4 MANUAL IDENTIFICATION AND HANDLING OF ERRORS AND IRREGULARITIES

An audience result in a country is erroneous or incomplete if an error is reported by an authenticated project manager of a T-Partner.

In this case ONCE will try to correct the error as quickly as possible based on the corrected result provided by the project manager. Otherwise, the erroneous or incomplete voting result will be eliminated.

An audience result in a country is presumably erroneous or incomplete, if

1. It contains 0 votes (except self-voting) for contesters, because normally each contester receives at least a few votes
2. It contains a very large televote peak value unless historic results or Diaspora can explain this voting pattern
3. It contains several identical large televote values

In such cases the pan-European voting partner will contact the authenticated project manager of a T-Partner and ask for a double check of the result. It is unlikely, but it cannot be 100% excluded that an error in a voting result is detected late after the final result has been announced. In that case, the late detection of an error will be handled as an event which must be reported to the EBU Incident & Crisis Managers.

The pan-European voting partner is comparing the transmitted results from the T-Partner with the Call Viewer. A call viewer is showing the incoming votes for all songs during the voting window. This procedure is an additional security step that all votes are transmitted correctly.

IDENTIFYING IRREGULAR AUDIENCE VOTES

An audience result in a country contains a significant irregularity, if*

1. It comprises one or two televotes value maximum peak which is at least approx. 3 times larger than the remaining values and/or
2. At the position of the maximum peak there is a significant deviation in the audience result from different T-Partner of that country (if existent) with respect to winner and televotes value and/or
3. At the position of the maximum peak there is a significant deviation in the national jury voting result of that country, i.e. the winner of the suspect audience is not among the upper ranks of the jury voting

An attempt of intentional and systematically organized mass voting is probable, if

1. A significant irregularity in the audience result is observed in several countries for one and the same participant and/or
2. There exist other hints or even evidence for mass voting

* The above approach to identify mass voting in audience results is based on the assumption that audience results of two different T-Partners in the same country should have a similar peak characteristic.

Also, a number one rank in audience voting should be reasonably “confirmed” by jury voting. Strong irregularities for a participant simultaneously in different countries may be an indication for organized mass voting.

HANDLING OF IRREGULARITIES IN AUDIENCE VOTING

If in countries where ONCE is not or only partially able to clearly identify a user and significant irregularities have been identified in audience results, **ONCE will have the authority in the name of the EBU to decide** if the affected audience results shall be eliminated. The decisions and the severity thereof will be taken based on judgment, taking into account the possible impact of significant irregularities on the winner(s) as well as the historic irregular behaviour of respective countries.

All decision by ONCE will be monitored and recorded by an Independent Voting Observer (EY).

Due to the POT-SYSTEM this method is limited to eliminating votes completely that appear to be fraudulent.

Either all the votes for a single song (DDI) from a single T-Partner source can be deleted or the entire votes for all songs delivered from a single T-Partner can be discarded.

The intervention is kept as low as possible by the automatic fraud detection system and the pot calculations. ONCE does everything possible to keep interventions as low as possible. The Fraud Detection System and the Pot calculations were developed for this situation.

5.5 ALLOWED NEIGHBORING AND DIASPORA VOTING

Some countries have a proven records of voting for certain other countries.

In these countries peaks in the voting for a respective artist are considered normal and do not constitute an irregularity.

Such votes shall not be removed from the voting score and are automatically protected.

Heartlist to be discussed

6. REST OF THE WORLD VOTING

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ONCE

6.1 VOTING WINDOW OF THE ROW

- The non-participating countries (RoW) have two voting windows in both semifinals:
 - The first voting windows for the RoW Audience open respectively after the end of the transmission of the Dress Rehearsal 2 of each Semi Final and close at the beginning of the respective Live broadcasts (approx. 00:00 – 21:00 CEST).
 - The second voting windows for the RoW Audience opens after the last performance in the Live Semi-Finals and closes 15-25 minutes later depending on the running order of the Shows.
- Similar to the Semi Finals, there are two voting windows for the RoW Audience in the Grand-Final.
 - The first window opens after the end of the transmission of the Dress Rehearsal 2 on Friday night and closes at the beginning of the Live broadcast on Saturday (approx. 00:00 – 21:00 CEST).
 - The second voting window opens before the start of the first performance in the live Show and closes approximately 25-40 minutes after the end of the last performance, depending on the running order of the Shows.
- If ONCE isn't provided with all required material to start the voting for the RoW countries, the start of the respective window has to be delayed

6.2 USAGE OF THE AUDIENCE VOTE

The votes of the non-participating countries via the RoW voting shall

- be combined and the sum of votes shall be used to determine the result of the “Rest of the World” country result;
- have the same voting power as one participating country (58 points).

With respect to the RoW voting, the song which has received the highest number of votes shall be ranked first, the song which has received the second highest number of votes shall be ranked second and so on until the last song.

In both Semi-Finals and in the Grand Final, only the ten best ranked songs in the RoW voting will be considered and

- (1) 12 points shall be allocated to the song having obtained the best rank from the audiences;
- (2) 10 points to the song having obtained the second-best rank from the audiences,
- (3) 8 points to the song having obtained the third-best combined rank from the audiences,
- (4) 7 points to the next,
- (5) and so on, down to 1 point for the song having obtained the tenth-best rank from the audiences.

Tie Situations in the RoW Voting are solved according to paragraph 1.2.1.

6.3 IDENTIFICATION AND HANDLING OF ERRORS AND IRREGULARITIES

Automatic Handling of Irregularities analog to chapter 5.3 will be applied.

If the voting partner is identifying significant irregularities, the voting partner will have the authority in the name of the EBU to decide if specific online votes or the votes from one or more non-participating countries will be eliminated. The decisions and the severity thereof will be taken based on judgment, taking into account the possible impact of significant irregularities on the winner(s).

All decisions by the voting partner will be monitored and recorded.

The voting partner does everything possible to keep interventions as low as possible.

Votes will be kept if they do not influence the winning country.

6.4 FALLBACK SCENARIOS

Technical or similar failures in the RoW voting are defined as

1. The RoW misses the voting threshold either by
 - a) generating too few votes by the audience;
 - b) the voting result transmitted from the RoW voting platform, or the Payment Provider is erroneous or incomplete.
2. No votes are recorded from the non-participating countries for any reason.

In the above-mentioned cases the RoW result will be calculated based on the Audience Voting result of Pot 0 (The pot of the Big 4, HB and the winner).

7. DISQUALIFICATION OF A PARTICIPANT

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DISQUALIFICATION DURING THE SHOW

- I. The EBU supervisor is entitled to disqualify a participant ***before the end of the voting window***, if
1. A contestant violates the rules of the Eurovision Song Contest in such a way that the integrity and reputation of the show is in his opinion threatened.
 2. The performance of an artist has changed in such a way that it does not reflect the pre-approved version submitted to the EBU and performed in the dress rehearsals.

In the event of disqualification of a participant before the end of the voting window, all votes for that particular entry shall be discarded and considered invalid.

For the avoidance of doubt,

- a) Even if a participant has been disqualified during the show, the result of the national jury and the votes of the audience from the participants country shall remain valid unless they are not in breach of paragraph 4 and/or 5.
- b) Due to technical restrictions, it is not possible to disqualify a song during the live show after the end of the televoting window.
- c) In order to re-calculate the results and removing disqualified participants, all jury results must be submitted with a complete ranking. (Should the EBU determine to return to a 12-point system for the juries, the disqualification of a song before the end of the voting window is not possible.)
- d) A respective country shall be allowed to vote in the Grand Final if their participant has been disqualified in the Semi-Final.

DISQUALIFICATION AFTER THE SHOW

II. The EBU may disqualify a participant **after the show** as stipulated in the official rules of the Eurovision Song Contest paragraph C.4.2.

In the event of disqualification after the show the respective country shall be placed last in the competition and his previous rank shall be filled by the succeeding countries.

For the avoidance of doubt,

- a) there shall be no recalculation of the result taking into account the disqualification of respective countries.
- b) The result of the national jury and the votes of the audience of the respective country shall remain valid unless they are not in breach of paragraph 4 and/or 5 .

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